**Roman Key Card Blackwood - 1430 version**

RKCB is similar to Blackwood, but instead of four Aces there are Five Keycards. They are the Aces plus the King of the agreed trump suit. Starting with 4NT, a reply of 5♣ shows 1 or 4 Keycards, 5♦ shows 0 or 3, 5♥ shows 2 Keycards but no trump Queen, and 5♠ shows 2 Keycards with the trump Queen.
If your side has all five Keycards, bidding 5NT will repeat the process for Kings, remembering that there are only three Kings since the trump King is counted as a Keycard. There are two popular methods for responding to 5NT. The first is the same as normal Blackwood - 6♣ shows no Kings, 6♦ shows one, and 6♥ shows three. This is the method used in the recommended bidding here.
If the response to 4NT is 5♣ or 5♦ the 4NT bidder may choose to ask about the trump Queen rather than ask for Kings. She does this by bidding the cheapest non-trump suit. Partner denies the trump Queen by returning to the trump suit. A 5NT bid confirms the trump Queen, but shows no outside Kings. Bidding any non-trump suit confirms the trump Queen and also the King of the suit bid.
Void showing by Responder is handled just as in regular Blackwood except it refers to one or two Keycards, rather than one or two Aces.

Board: 1
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 5♣
Declarer: North
Lead: ♥A

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 6♠
Declarer: East
Lead: ♣4

Board: 3
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 7♠
Declarer: South
Lead: ♦A

Board: 4
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 6♥
Declarer: West
Lead: ♦5

Board: 5
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 7NT
Declarer: North
Lead: ♥6

Board: 6
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 6♠
Declarer: East
Lead: ♥K

***Board 1***
South Deals
None Vul

♠ K Q 7
♥ J 6
♦ A 6 4
♣ Q J 10 8 7

♠ 9 8 5 3 2
♥ 10 5 4 3
♦ J 10
♣ 5 4




♠ A J 10 4
♥ A 9
♦ 9 8 7 5 3 2
♣ 2

♠ 6
♥ K Q 8 7 2
♦ K Q
♣ A K 9 6 3

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | 1♥ |
| Pass | 2♣ | Pass | 4NT[1] |
| Pass | 5♣[2] | | |
| All Pass | | | |

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 1 or 4 key cards

5♣ by North
Lead: ♥A

This is the companion to Deal 6. The cards are the same except that the ♦s and ♣s have been swapped.

Again, SOUTH has no problem as long as NORTH holds at least one Key-card. When NORTH responds 5♣, (showing one Key-card), SOUTH can pass.

That's what happens here.

***Board 2***
East Deals
N-S Vul

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | ♠ 10 3<br>♥ A K 8 6<br>♦ 10 8 7 2<br>♣ 10 6 3 | |
| ♠ K Q J 8 7 5 2<br>♥ 4<br>♦ K 6<br>♣ A K 5 |  | ♠ A 9 6<br>♥ Q J 10 3<br>♦ A Q J<br>♣ Q J 9 |
| | ♠ 4<br>♥ 9 7 5 2<br>♦ 9 5 4 3<br>♣ 8 7 4 2 | |

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | 1NT | Pass |
| 4♣ | Pass | 4♠ | Pass |
| 6♠ | | | |
| All Pass | | | |

6♠ by East
Lead: ♣4

WEST needs to know how many Aces EAST holds.

One way to find out would be to bid 3♠, (which is forcing), then launch Blackwood.

Another way is to bid 4♣ (Gerber) right now.

The first way is probably better but we needed a Gerber example.

***Board 3***
North Deals
None Vul

♠ A J 10 5
♥ A K
♦ K 5
♣ A K Q J 4

♠ 9 6
♥ 8 6 4 2
♦ A 10 8 6 2
♣ 10 3




♠ 2
♥ J 10 9 3
♦ Q J 9 7 4 3
♣ 8 5

♠ K Q 8 7 4 3
♥ Q 7 5
♦ —
♣ 9 7 6 2

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | 2♣ | Pass | 2♠ |
| Pass | 4NT | Pass | 6♦ |
| Pass | 7♠ | | |
| All Pass | | | |

7♠ by South
Lead: ♦A

SOUTH's positive response shows 8+ points and five or more cards headed by at least two honors.

NORTH figures a small slam would be safe, but just to be sure she uses Blackwood.

SOUTH's 6♦ reply shows one Key-card which must be the trump King, and a ♦ void!.

NORTH readjusts her thinking and decides to bid the Grand.

***Board 4***
East Deals
Both Vul

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | ♠ 10 9 5 4<br>♥ 6 4<br>♦ 5 2<br>♣ J 10 5 4 2 | |
| ♠ A 6<br>♥ A Q 8 7 5 2<br>♦ K Q 3<br>♣ 8 7 |  | ♠ K Q 3<br>♥ K 10 9 3<br>♦ A 6<br>♣ K Q 9 6 |
| | ♠ J 8 7 2<br>♥ J<br>♦ J 10 9 8 7 4<br>♣ A 3 | |

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | 1NT | Pass |
| 3♥ | Pass | 4NT[1] | Pass |
| 5♠[2] | Pass | 6♥ | |
| All Pass | | | |

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 2 key cards with the trump queen

6♥ by West
Lead: ♦5

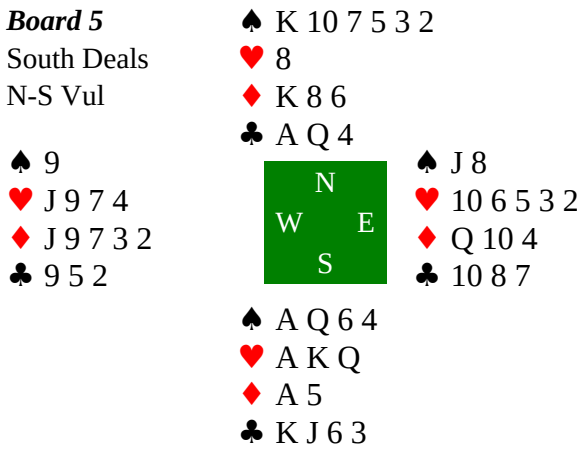
WEST jumps in ♥s, showing a good suit and slam interest.

EAST has great ♥ support so bids RKCB 4NT.

WEST responds 5♠, showing two Key Cards and the ♥Q.

That is enough for EAST to bid the slam.

***Board 5***
South Deals
N-S Vul




| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | 2♣ |
| Pass | 2♠ | Pass | 3♠ |
| Pass | 4NT[1] | Pass | 5♦[2] |
| Pass | 5♥ | Pass | 6♣ |
| Pass | 7NT | | |
| All Pass | | | |

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 0 or 3 key cards

7NT by North
Lead: ♥6

When SOUTH agrees to ♠s, NORTH will not stop short of a slam. The RKCB 4NT bid tells NORTH that they have all five Key Cards since SOUTH could hardly have a 2♣ opening hand with no Aces.

NORTH's 5♥ bid is the Queen Ask, and SOUTH's reply confirms that she holds the ♠Q, and also has the ♣K.

NORTH figures the ♠ suit will run, and this should be enough for Grand Slam. He chooses 7NT.

***Board 6***
West Deals
E-W Vul

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | ♠ 10 9 4<br>♥ 10 9 6 2<br>♦ 9 6 3<br>♣ 9 3 2 | |
| ♠ Q 8 6<br>♥ Q J 3<br>♦ A J 5<br>♣ A J 6 5 |  | ♠ A K 7 5 3<br>♥ 8<br>♦ K Q 7 2<br>♣ K Q 4 |
| | ♠ J 2<br>♥ A K 7 5 4<br>♦ 10 8 4<br>♣ 10 8 7 | |

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1NT | Pass | 3♠ | Pass |
| 4♠ | Pass | 4NT[1] | Pass |
| 5♠[2] | Pass | 6♠ | |
| All Pass | | | |

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 2 key cards with the trump queen

6♠ by East
Lead: ♥K

EAST knows there are enough points for slam, but she is worried about the trump suit. WEST's support doesn't guarantee more than three ♠s, and if they are not headed by the Queen she could lose a trump trick.

Her RKCB bid relieves her mind when EAST claims two Key Cards PLUS the ♠Q. She bids 6♠ (and hopes for a 3-2 trump split!).